ASCII Master Flowchart — Babur & the Central Asian Backdrop

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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/12: Central Asian political field
TIMURID FRAGMENTS -> competing princes and unstable coalitions
UZBEKS / SHAIBANI -> pressure and consolidation in Transoxiana
SAFAVIDS / SHAH ISMAIL -> temporary opening after Merv, 1510
OTTOMANS / CHALDIRAN, 1514 -> regional balance shifts indirectly
BABUR -> Farghana and Samarqand claimant searching for a durable base
RULE: regional geopolitics constrained agency; it did not cause Panipat alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/12: Babur chronology 1494-1530
1494 Farghana -> 1497 / 1501 Samarqand captures and losses
1504 Kabul -> 1510 Merv opening -> 1514 Chaldiran context
1519-20 Bhira and Sialkot -> November 1525 final march
1526 Panipat -> 1527 Khanwa -> 1528 Chanderi -> 1529 Ghagra
30 December 1530 -> Babur dies at Agra
MEMORY: Central Asian constraint -> Indian opening -> staged consolidation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/12: Layered identity and legitimacy
PATERNAL -> Timurid descent and sovereign prestige
MATERNAL -> Chagatai / Chingizid association
MILITARY-POLITICAL -> Turco-Mongol practices and mobile cavalry world
CULTURAL -> Persianate court culture + Chagatai Turkish literary expression
INDIAN DYNASTIC LABEL -> Mughal
TRAP: identity explains legitimacy and networks, not biological destiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/12: Samarqand cycle: prestige versus resources
SAMARQAND -> Timurid legitimacy + affluent strategic centre
CAPTURE -> symbolic success
SUPPLY + MONEY + HINTERLAND + FOLLOWER LOYALTY -> insufficient
UZBEK PRESSURE + unstable coalitions -> repeated loss
LEARNING -> manoeuvre, resource discipline and limits of city possession
OUTCOME -> Central Asian failure redirects rather than predestines policy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/12: Kabul-Qandahar strategic bridge
KABUL 1504 -> survival base, recruitment and southward platform
QANDAHAR -> rear security and Iranian-Central Asian interface
KABUL -> routes toward Kashgar, China, Transoxiana and Turkistan
QANDAHAR -> routes toward Khurasan, Iran and West Asia
LIMIT -> route potential did not automatically solve fiscal weakness
BRIDGE -> Indian agrarian resources + north-western security and trade.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/12: Punjab and the Lodi opening
BABUR'S EARLIER PUNJAB MOVES + TIMURID CLAIMS
                    |
IBRAHIM LODI-NOBLE TENSIONS + DAULAT KHAN + ALAM KHAN
                    |
local opening, information and favourable timing
                    |
BABUR EXPANDS BEYOND THE INVITERS' LIMITED PURPOSE
FORMULA: external push + internal opening + converting agency.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/12: Final march and Panipat frontage
NOVEMBER 1525 -> Babur leaves Kabul after securing rear and flank
 -> Punjab movement and communication control
 -> narrow prepared frontage at Panipat
 -> carts linked by raw-hide ropes + breastworks + firing positions
 -> gaps retained for cavalry action
TRAP: not a straight unprepared ride from Kabul to one battle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/12: Panipat combined-arms system
FIRE -> artillery and matchlockmen under Ustad Ali and Mustafa
FIX -> carts, ropes, breastworks and constrained frontage
MOVE -> mounted archery, cavalry gaps and tulghuma flanking
COMMAND -> sequencing, reserve use and battlefield coordination
CONTEXT -> Ibrahim's organisation and deployment also matter
VERDICT: guns were important inside a system, never a solitary miracle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/12: After Panipat: decision to stay
PANIPAT -> Delhi-Agra centre opens
BUT -> forts resist + Afghans remain + begs dislike India + supplies strain
BABUR DISTRIBUTES WEALTH + appeals to followers + chooses settlement
INDIAN RESOURCES -> support a new political base
RESULT -> invasion begins to become state formation
LIMIT -> Humayun and the Sur interregnum expose continuing fragility.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/12: Panipat-Khanwa-Ghagra ladder
PANIPAT 1526 -> Ibrahim Lodi -> removes the Delhi sultanate centre
KHANWA 1527 -> Rana Sanga coalition -> checks a rival north Indian alignment
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CHANDERI 1528 -> bounded follow-through against a Rajput stronghold
GHAGRA 1529 -> eastern Afghan resistance in a Bengal-linked setting
TACTICS may recur; opponents, theatres and political functions change
TRAP: consolidation was staged, not complete in April 1526.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/12: Baburnama and heritage source method
BABURNAMA -> Chagatai Turkish first-person chronology and observation
STRENGTH -> routes, places, campaigns, gardens and ruler perception
LIMIT -> selective memory, self-fashioning, rhetoric and number inflation
BAGH-E BABUR -> tomb, terraces, water works and layered later interventions
UNESCO -> archaeology, documents, images and conservation reconstruction
RULE: material heritage can corroborate context, not every memoir claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/12: Topic 12 answer spine
OPEN -> Central Asian failure made India attractive, not inevitable
PUSH -> Timurid fragmentation + Uzbek pressure + Kabul resource limits
OPENING -> Punjab claims + Lodi fissures + invitations
MECHANISM -> prepared combined arms and Babur's command
CONSOLIDATION -> decision to stay + Panipat-Khanwa-Ghagra ladder
CLOSE -> a real but fragile Mughal foundation joined two strategic worlds.
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